

IBM Test Pattern

The written test consists of two sections each of 45 minutes duration

Section#1

This is the aptitude section consisting of 45 questions to be attempted in 45 minutes. As is in all the exams, this section is based on the MBA pattern of examination.

Section#2

this is the technical section. There is a separate paper for hardware and software. Candidates have to mention beforehand whether they want to write the software or the hardware paper. This section also carries 45 questions to be completed in 45 minutes.

Interview

There are two rounds of interviews, viz., the technical and the HR round

Technical and Personal Round for Software Candidates

Mainly subjective questions in C, Operating Systems, DBMS, Data Structures are asked interspersed with some on the candidate's personal background.

Typical questions in C and Data Structures

1. WAP to interchange 2 variables without using the third one
2. Explain quick sort and merge sort algorithms and derive the time-constraint relation for these.
3. Explain binary searching, fibonacci search
4. General questions on binary trees, transversals
5. General questions on graphs and their representation.

Typical Questions on Operating Systems

1. Demand paging, page faults, replacement algos, thrashing, etc
2. Paged segmentation and segment paging

In this section, case studies are presented before the candidate to perceive his reaction and his/her communication skills are tested. IBM expects teamwork and team spirit from the candidates and their answers should reflect this attitude

Typical question is

You are a project manager of a big multinational project. There is a person X, assigned to you who has the best technical skills required for the project, even better than you. But he wishes to be the project manager, which the management does not permit, due to which he threatens to quit. All others in the group are not as competent. Talk yourself out of this situation pretending that the interviewer is the disgruntled employee and explain the necessary action.

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